

Smart Peer Companion : Student Sentiment & Market Validation Report

1. Executive Summary

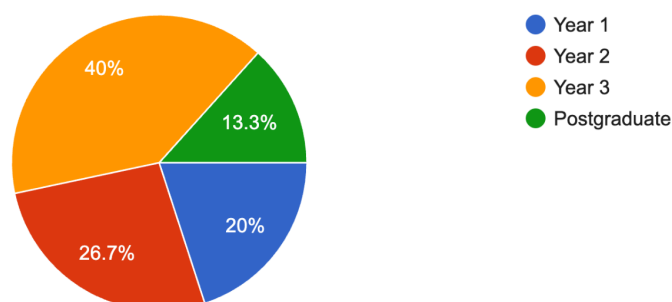
- **Objective:** To validate the market need for a peer-to-peer collaborative study platform augmented with a localized, on-demand AI (Smart Peer Companion).
- **Sample Size:** 15 university students.
- **Key Finding:** There is a critical gap in current study methods. 73.3% of students struggle to organize coursework or lose files in standard messaging apps. Furthermore, 86.7% of students distrust current AI tools because they either hallucinate or lack specific syllabus context. The data strongly supports the development of a structured, local-AI-assisted study platform.

2. Demographic Breakdown

- **Data Summary:** The survey captured a highly relevant target audience, primarily consisting of upper-level undergraduates who have established study habits. The largest group is Year 3 students (46.7%), followed by Year 2 (26.7%), Year 1 (13.3%), and Postgraduates (13.3%).

What is your current year of study?

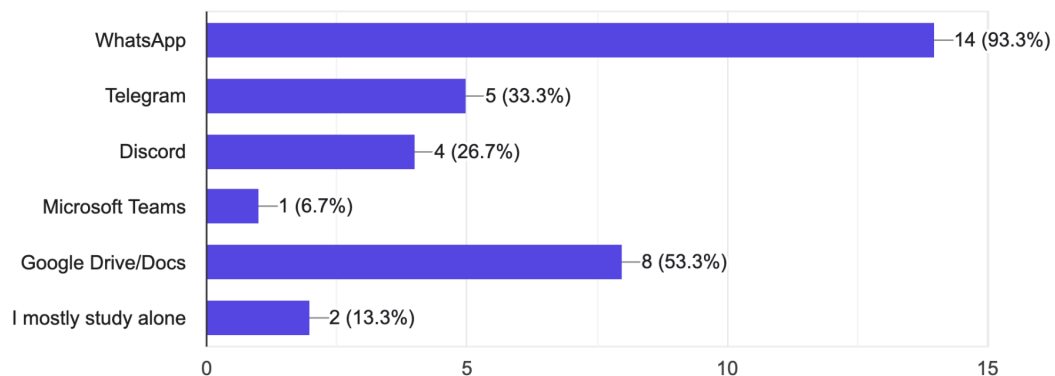
15 responses



- **Current Platform Usage:** WhatsApp is overwhelmingly the default communication tool, used by 13 out of 15 respondents (86.7%). Google Drive/Docs is the secondary tool for file storage (53.3%). Discord and Telegram see moderate use, highlighting a highly fragmented workflow where students are forced to jump between apps to chat and view files.

Which platforms do you currently use to study and share notes with your university peers? (Select all that apply)

15 responses

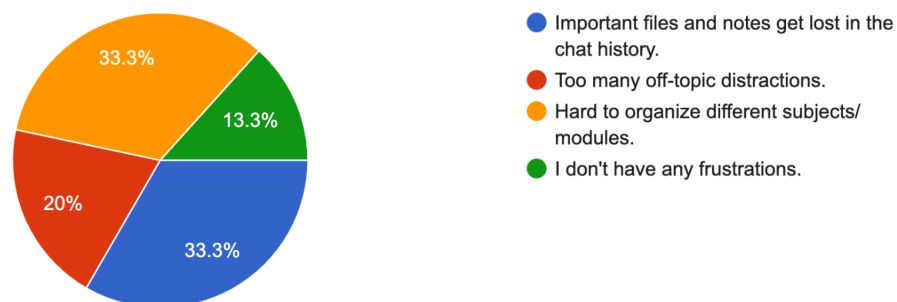


3. Problem Domain Validation (The Loopholes)

- **Communication Frustrations:** Standard messaging apps are failing students academically. The primary pain points are structural: 40% of students say it is "Hard to organize different subjects/modules," and 33.3% say "Important files and notes get lost in the chat history." This validates the need for a channel-based "Discord-style" architecture tailored specifically for coursework.

What is the biggest frustration when discussing coursework or sharing notes in standard group chats (like WhatsApp/Telegram)?

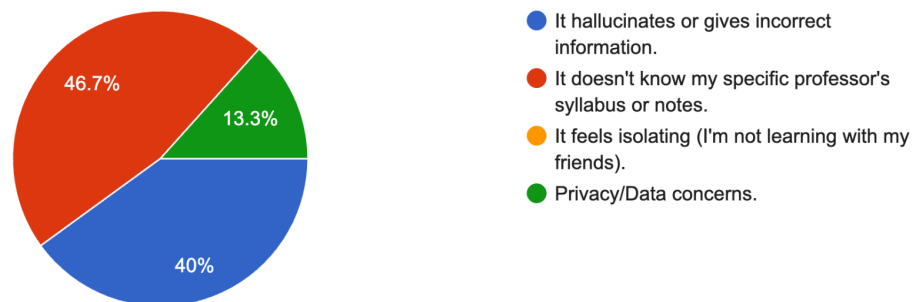
15 responses



- **Generative AI Concerns:** Students are deeply skeptical of generic AI. 46.7% say their biggest concern is that the AI "doesn't know my specific professor's syllabus or notes," while 40% are most worried that "it hallucinates or gives incorrect information." This perfectly justifies our SPC architecture: by using a local AI that *only* parses uploaded PDFs, we eliminate hallucination and guarantee syllabus accuracy.

When using AI (like ChatGPT or Claude) for university work, what is your biggest concern?

15 responses

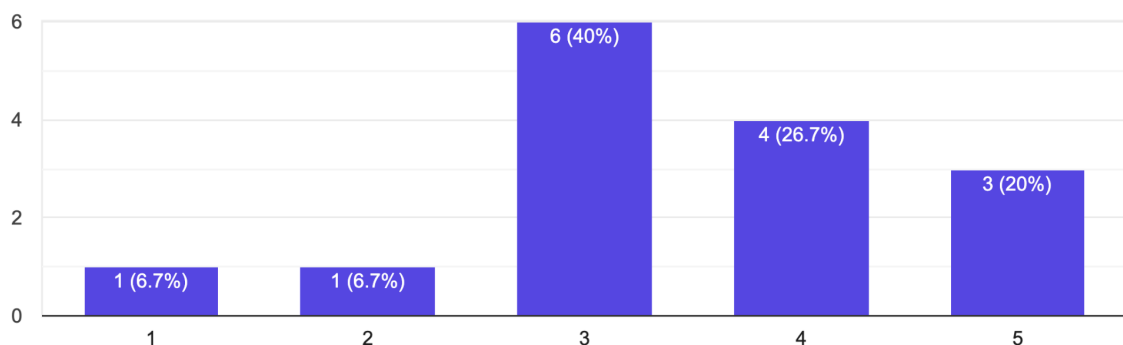


4. Solution Validation & Feature Demand

- **The Value of Peer Learning:** When asked if they learn better by discussing complex topics with peers rather than relying solely on textbooks or AI, 60% of students agreed or strongly agreed (scoring 4 or 5). The average score was 3.73 / 5. This proves that an "AI-only" tool is not what students want; they want a social platform first.
- **Likelihood of Adoption:** When pitched the Smart Peer Companion concept, 86.6% of respondents were neutral to extremely likely to use it (scoring 3, 4, or 5), with an average score of 3.47 / 5.

If there was a dedicated "Discord-style" study app that organized your PDFs/notes, and featured an AI bot you could summon into the group chat to sum...ur study group, how likely would you be to use it?

15 responses



- **Feature Requests (Direct User Quotes):** The open-ended responses strongly aligned with our Product Backlog, validating several planned features:
 1. **AI Functionality:** Respondents desire an AI agent that is locally processed and privacy-oriented, capable of locating specific information within a chat. Another suggested feature is an AI that can accurately identify the user's need (e.g., the type of notes required) and help find relevant, existing

conversations related to a user's doubt, eliminating the need to manually scroll through all conversations.

2. **Study and Notes Management:** Requested features include the ability to categorize notes for easy access and a function where users can post doubts to start new conversations that others with similar questions or answers can join.
3. **Customization and Learning Focus:** One respondent suggested a friendly AI customization feature through Multiple Choice Questions (MCQ) instead of prompts, while another expressed a desire for less reliance on AI outsourcing and more features focused on helping students use their own critical thinking.